

# Dr Javier Fajardo

DICE, University of Kent

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## Research profile

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I am a conservation scientist researching how area-based conservation can be planned, governed, implemented and recognised to achieve effective and equitable conservation outcomes. My research combines spatial and quantitative analyses with interdisciplinary approaches to evaluate conservation effectiveness, support conservation planning and understand the social dimensions of global biodiversity policy. I am particularly interested in understanding how biodiversity policy can be translated into effective and equitable area-based conservation across diverse ecological and social contexts.

## Current positions

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### **Postdoctoral Researcher, DICE, University of Kent (2026–present)**

Conservation Data Justice (CONDJUST) project. I am researching how equity and justice can be better integrated into the planning and implementation of area-based conservation. I am producing guidance on the appropriate use of ecological and socioeconomic datasets commonly used in spatial conservation planning to help researchers make appropriate use of them by recognising both their strengths and limitations. I am also conceptualising methodological approaches that better recognise positive human contributions to biodiversity.

## Education

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### **PhD in Ecology and Conservation, Universidad Internacional Menéndez Pelayo, CSIC-UIMP, Spain (2019)**

Thesis: *Optimising the design of protected area networks in tropical Andean countries.*

Supervisors: Jesús Muñoz and Rubén G. Mateo. Awarded *Cum Laude*.

### **MSc in “Tropical Biodiversity Conservation”, CSIC-UIMP, Spain (2012)**

Thesis: *Identification of priority areas for conservation in Peru using systematic conservation planning and species distribution models.*

Supervisors: Jesús Muñoz and Janeth Lessmann. Awarded First Class Honours.

### **Degree in Social and Cultural Anthropology, Universidad Nacional de Educación a Distancia (UNED), Spain (2010)**

### **Degree in Biology, University of Granada, Spain (2008)**

## Research outputs

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### Peer-reviewed articles

- Addoah T, **Fajardo J**, et al. (2026) Cocoa expansion displaces food crops into protected forests, but sustainability programmes reduce loss *Nature Communications Earth & Environment*.
- Tomba AN, **Fajardo J**, et al. (2026). From rock and ice to political convenience: persistent biases in Argentina's protected areas. *Perspectives in Ecology and Conservation*.
- Fajardo J**, Bingham HC, Brockington D, et al. (2026) Social implications of the 30x30 global conservation target. *Nature Communications* **17**: 4067. [DOI](#).
- Tomba, AN, **Fajardo J**, et al. (2026) Economic priorities shape protected area placement: the role of land competition in Argentina. *Biological Conservation* **313**: 111594. [DOI](#).
- Fajardo J**, Brockington D, Fitzsimons J, et al. (2025) Reflections from interdisciplinary research on the social implications of implementing 30×30, *PARKS* **31.2**, 122:128. [DOI](#).
- Garrett R, **Fajardo J**, et al. (2025) Policy principles for sustainable and just land systems, *Royal Society Open Science* **12**,10: 250810. [DOI](#).
- Blanco-Pastor JL, **Fajardo J**, Fernández de Castro AG, et al. (2025) Environmental data do not correlate with plant genetic diversity in alpine ecosystems. *Ecology and Evolution* **15**:5: e71332. [DOI](#).
- Lessmann J, Geldmann J, **Fajardo J**, and Marquet PA (2024) The role of funding in the performance of Latin America's protected areas. *PNAS* **121**:36, e2307521121. [DOI](#).
- Sandbrook, C, **Fajardo J**, et al. (2023) Social considerations are crucial to success in implementing the 30×30 global conservation target. *Nature Ecology & Evolution* **7**, 784–785. [DOI](#).
- Fajardo J**, Lessmann L, et al. (2023) The performance of protected-area expansions in representing tropical Andean species: Past Trends and Climate Change Prospects. *Scientific Reports* **13**, 1: 966. [DOI](#).
- Wang CJ, Wan JZ, **Fajardo J** (2021) Effects of agricultural lands on the distribution pattern of genus diversity for neotropical terrestrial vertebrates. *Ecological Indicators* **1**;129:107900. [DOI](#).
- Delso Á, **Fajardo J**, Muñoz J (2021) Protected area networks do not represent unseen biodiversity. *Scientific Reports*. **11** :12275. [DOI](#).
- Fajardo J**, Corcoran D, Roehrdanz PR, et al. (2020). GCM compareR: A web application to assess differences and assist in the selection of general circulation models for climate change research. *Methods in Ecology and Evolution*, **11**(5), 656-663. [DOI](#).
- Bondé L, **Fajardo J**, et al. (2020) Scenario-modelling for the sustainable management of non-timber forest products in tropical ecosystems. *Biota Neotropica* **5**:20. [DOI](#).
- Hannah L, **Fajardo J**, et al. (2020), 30% land conservation and climate action reduces tropical extinction risk by more than 50%. *Ecography*, **43**: 943-953. [DOI](#).
- Fajardo J**, Mateo RG, Vargas P, et al. (2019) The role of abiotic mechanisms of long-distance dispersal in the American origin of the Galápagos flora. *Global Ecology and Biogeography*. [DOI](#).
- Lessmann J, **Fajardo J**, Bonaccorso E, Bruner A (2019) Cost-effective protection of biodiversity in the western Amazon. *Biological conservation* **235**, 250-259. [DOI](#).
- Oleas NH, Feeley KJ, **Fajardo J**, et al. (2019) Muddy boots beget wisdom: A cautionary tale for species distribution models of endangered species. *Diversity*, **11** (10), 1-11. [DOI](#).
- Fuentes-Castillo T, **Fajardo J**, et al. (2019) Modelling the current and future biodiversity distribution in the Chilean Mediterranean Hotspot. The role of protected areas network in a warmer future. *Diversity and Distributions*, **25** (12), 1897-1909. [DOI](#).

Lessmann J, **Fajardo J**, Muñoz J, Bonaccorso E (2016) Large expansion of oil industry in one of the most biodiverse areas of the world: biodiversity vulnerability and conservation alternatives for the Ecuadorian Amazon. *Ecology and Evolution* 4 (14), 4997-5012. [DOI](#).

**Fajardo J**, Lessmann J, Bonaccorso E, Devenish C & Muñoz J (2014) Combined use of systematic conservation planning, species distribution models, and connectivity analysis reveals severe conservation gaps in a megadiverse country (Peru). *PloS ONE* 9: e114367. [DOI](#).

### **Book chapters and selected policy outputs and science communications**

Sandbrook C, **Fajardo J** (2026) Conserving 30% of the planet will only succeed if people are part of the plan, *The Conversation*. [Link](#). [Versión en español](#).

Morales D, **Fajardo J**, et al. (2025) Chapter on protected areas and environmental peacebuilding. In *Paz Ambiental: Ecos de La Naturaleza En La Transformación Social*. Instituto CAPAZ e Instituto Humboldt. [Link](#).

### **Past positions**

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**Postdoctoral Researcher, ICTA-UAB, Spain (2025–present)**

Conservation Data Justice (CONDJUST) project.

**Visiting Postdoctoral Researcher, Conservation Research Institute, University of Cambridge, UK (2025–present)**

**Research Associate, Department of Geography, University of Cambridge, UK (2023–2025)**

SNAPP Project [The Social Implications of 30x30](#).

**Programme Officer (Science Programme), UNEP-WCMC, UK (2019–2023)**

### **Teaching experience**

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**Course Lecturer, MSc Tropical Biodiversity Conservation, CSIC-UIMP, Spain (2017–present)**

MSc course *Tools for the Planning of Protected Area Networks*. Previously taught MSc courses in *Species Distribution Models* and *Geographic Information Systems* within the same programme.

**Lecturer and supervisor, University of Cambridge (2024)**

Within “Life Within Limits” undergraduate Geography course.

Co-Supervisor of one PhD student (Universidad de Córdoba, Argentina) and of three MSc students (CISC-UIMP, Spain)

### **Academic service and professional contributions**

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**Guest Editor, Scientific Reports (2026–present).** Collection *Spatial Prioritisation for Nature Recovery*.

**Proposal Reviewer, SNAPP Science Advisory Council (SAC) (2026).**

**Contact point, Convention of Biological Diversity (CBD) Academia and Research Organisation Group (2026–present).** [Link](#)

**Board Member, Society for Conservation Biology Latin America and Caribbean Section** (membership-elected position). Former Director of Membership (2019–2024) and Nominations (2024).

### **Selected international presentations and policy engagement**

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**POLLEN 2026, Barcelona, Spain (July 2026).** Presented *Who could be affected by the 30×30 conservation target? Exploring its social implications* in the panel *Redefining Global Biodiversity Conservation Governance through 30×30*.

**IUCN World Conservation Congress, Abu Dhabi, UAE (2025).** Presented research on social implications of 30×30 implementation.

**Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD) COP16, Cali, Colombia (2024).** Presented SNAPP research across three Target 3 science-policy events.

**Geo for Good 2022, Google, Palo Alto, California, USA (2022).**

**LACA Conservation Latin America 2020, online (2020).**

**Latin American and Caribbean Congress for Conservation Biology (LACCCB) 2018.** Port of Spain, Trinidad and Tobago (2018).

**International Congress for Conservation Biology (ICCB) 2017, Cartagena, Colombia (2017).**